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APPLY COMPREHENSION SKILLS TO ENGAGE ORAL TEXTS IN A BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT
US12154
Section A
Question 1
a) 1. Listen actively:Give full attention, avoid interruptions, and maintain eye contact.
2. Take notes: Jot down key words, names, dates, and facts while listening.
3. Identify key words and phrases: Listen for repeated words, tone changes, and emphasized points.
4. Verify understandin: Ask clarifying questions or paraphrase back to confirm details.
b) Identify the important information
Group the important information
Combine the groups to get the main idea
c) 1. Context: When and where did the incident happen.
2. Sequence of events: The order in which actions took place.
Question 2
a)1.Categorize queries:Group by product, service, billing, technical issue, etc.
2. Use a comparison chart: List common keywords and problems side by side.
3.Look for repeated words/phrases:Similar language often means similar problems.
4. Check customer history: See if it's the same issue recurring.
5.identify root cause: Different complaints may stem from

the same underlying problem.
6.Note differences in urgency, tone, and expected outcome.
b)1. Greet the customer politely and introduce yourself.
2. Listen actively without interrupting.
3. Show empathy: "I understand how frustrating that must be."
4. Ask open-ended questions to get full information.
5. Take accurate notes of all details.
6. Use simple, clear language - avoid jargon.
7. Be honest - if you don't know, say so and find out.
8.Provide correct and complete information from reliable sources.
9.Confirm understanding by summarizing back.
10. Offer solutions/options and explain next steps.
11. Maintain a positive and professional tone throughout.
12. Close politely and thank the customer for contacting you.
c)Analytical people are systematic, well organized and deliberate,for instance an assessor wanting learners to submit tasks on time with evidence included
Driver ,thrive on the thrill of a challenge and intentional motivation to succeed, they are practical and direct,for instance a learner doing an assessment the day before the submission date
Amiable customers are dependable, loyal and easygoing.They are quick to reach a decision,for instance a customer buying fatcakes at a street vendor will choose one street vendor regularly and also have patience to wait for the fatcakes

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Question 3
a) 1.By topic: Group information into categories like product, service, complaint
2. By importance: Separate main points from supporting details.
3.By sequence:Arrange information in chronological order.4. By fact vs opinion: Distinguish factual data from feelings or assumptions.
b)1. Closed questions: "Is your account number 12345?" - for confirming facts.
2. Open questions: "Can you tell me more about what happened?" - for more detail.
3. Paraphrasing: "So you're saying the delivery was 2 days late, correct?"
4. Reflective questions: "What I hear you saying is that you're unhappy with the service. Is that right?"
c) 1. Customer records/files - previous interactions and history.
2. Product/service manuals - for accurate technical details.
3. Company policies and procedures - to structure the correct response.
Question 4
a) 1. Listen to the entire message first without interrupting.
2. Identify the main purpose of the oral text - why is the speaker talking.
3. Pick out key points and supporting details. Ignore repetition and filler words.
4Note important facts: names, dates, numbers, actions.

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5. Organize points logically- usually in the order they were presented.
6. Use your own words- don't just copy what was said.
7. Keep it short and clear - include only essential information.8. Review and verify with the speaker: "To confirm, the summary is..."
b)1. Customer feedback- calls, complaints, surveys
2.Company policies and procedures
3. Product/service manuals
4. Internal memos and emails
5. Meeting minutes
6. Training materials
7. Colleagues and supervisors
8.Customer databases
9. Incident reports
10. Industry news and updates
11. FAQ documents
12. Previous oral conversations/recordings
c)1. Listen actively to tone, pauses, and emphasis.
2. Look for context clues - situation, background, and environment
3. Consider body language if face-to-face - facial expressions, gestures
4.Relate to prior knowledge - what do you already know about the topic.
5. Ask clarifying questions to confirm assumptions.
6. Summarize to check if your inference matches the speaker's intent.

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Question 5
a)1.Complaint: Customer called to complain about late delivery of a product.
2. Query: Customer asked about refund policy after buying a faulty item.
3. Request: Customer requested to upgrade their internet package.
4. Compliment: Customer praised staff for excellent customer service.
b) 1. Late delivery complaint → Customer lost trust and may take business elsewhere.
2. Refund query→ If handled well, customer satisfaction increases and loyalty is built.
3. Upgrade request → Leads to increased sales and revenue for the organisation.
4. Compliment→ Boosts staff morale and improves company reputation.
c) 1. Incident/Complaint logbooks - to compare past and present cases.
2.Customer feedback forms-to see patterns over time
3. Staff reports and meeting minutes - to identify trends and changes
Question 6
a)1Listen for tone and emotion- anger may suggest a negative cause.
2. Look at sequence of events - what happened first and what followed.
3. Use prior knowledge - relate to similar situations you've

heard before.
4.Ask probing questions - "What led to that happening?"
b)1.Check against facts-compare with company records and data.
2. Verify source credibility - is the speaker reliable and knowledgeable.
3. Consider company policy - is the idea acceptable within rules.
4. Evaluate benefits- will it help the customer and business = desirability/worth.
5. Assess feasibility- do we have resources to make it happen.
6 Look at past outcomes- has something similar worked before
7. Check for bias- is the information one-sided.
8. Consult colleagues/supervisorfor a second opinion
9. Consider customer needs - does it meet their expectations.
10. Weigh probabilities - based on trends, is it likely to occur/ succeed.
c) 1. Check relevance - does it address the customer's query/ problem.
2. Check clarity- is the message clear and understandable.
3. Check appropriateness- is the language and tone suitable for the audience.
4. Check outcome - did it achieve the intended goal, e.g. resolve issue.
Question 7
a)company databases,prody manuals and policy documents

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4. Financial records
5.Customer history files
6. Supervisor/manager input
7. Industry standards and regulations
8. Training materials
9.Previous case studies
10. Customer feedback surveys
11.Quality assurance reports
12.External sources - e.g. supplier info, news
b) 1. Accuracy - Is it factual and verifiable.
2. Relevance - Does it relate to the query or purpose.
3. Credibility of source - Is the speaker trustworthy.
4.Alignment with policy- Does it follow company rules and values.

Section B PRACTICAL APPLICATION
TASK 1
CUSTOMER 1: BRENDA - Phone Call - Dreams Ltd IT Manager
a) Main details from the conversation*
1. Company: Dreams Ltd
2. Position: IT Manager
3. Product bought: Software for capturing customer orders and monitoring delivery
4. Problem: IT technician did not install software properly
5. Reason: Technician did not read the user manual or follow procedures
6. Request in Call 1: Asking if your company can help with installation

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7. Request in Call 2: Asking about installation + information on different software
b) Main idea of the query
The main idea of Brenda's query is to get technical assistance with software installation and to get information about purchasing additional software for other departments.
c) Incidents/actions in correct sequence
1. First: Dreams Ltd bought software for capturing orders and monitoring delivery.
2. Second: IT technician failed to install it because he did not follow the manual/procedures.
3. Third: Brenda made first call to ask for help with installation.
4. Fourth:Brenda made second call to ask about installation again + about different software.
d) Compare with previous queries - Similarities and Differences
Similarity:Both calls are about software installation from Dreams Ltd.
Difference:First call was only about fixing current software. Second call added a new request for information on different software.
e) Answer using known FAQ/known answers
Response: "Yes Ms Brenda, we provide installation support for all software purchased from us. I can also send you our catalog for other software solutions that may suit other departments."

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f)Verbal clues and personality
Personality:Professional, Business-like, Organized

Verbal clues:Speaks clearly, gives company position, lists 2 separate requests logically, refers back to previous call.

CUSTOMER 2: MANGI - Face to Face - Businessman from JHB
a) Main details from the conversation
1. Name: Mr Mangi
2. Location: Johannesbur
3. Product bought: Software, 4 months ago
4. Problem: Software is not working properly
5. Action: Came to the office to log a complaint
6. Urgency: Wants it fixed immediately

b) Main idea of the query
The main idea of Mangi's query is to lodge a complaint about faulty software purchased 4 months ago and to request urgent technical support.
c) Incidents/actions in correct sequence
1. First:Mangi bought software 4 months ago.
2. Second: The software started not working properly.
3. Third:Mangi came to the office to log a complaint.

d) Compare with previous queries - Similarities and Differences
Similarity:Both Brenda and Mangi have problems with software not working/installation.

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Difference:Brenda’s issue is installation error by technician.
Mangi’s issue is faulty software after 4 months of use.
Brenda called, Mangi came in person.
e) Answer using known FAQ/known answers
Response: "Mr Mangi, we have a warranty and technical support policy for all software. I will log your complaint now and our technician will contact you within 24 hours to resolve the issue."
f) Verbal clues - Customer Personality
Personality: Direct / Driver / Dominant / Impatient
Verbal clues: Tells you what to do, raises voice, says "Don’t interrupt me", wants immediate action, uses short direct sentences.

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Summative assessment
SECTION A
1. C
2.B
3.B
4. D
5.A
6.D
7.D
8.C
9.D
10.D